

Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

VIA C3 Processor on VIA C3M266 motherboard

Cool processing

The new 1 GHz processor from VIA is based on the Nehemiah core, which dissipates very little heat, and has enhanced multimedia capabilities—thanks to the SSE instruction set. It is one of the X86-based



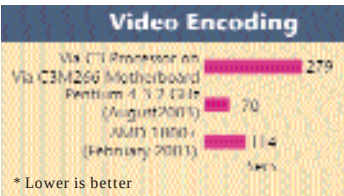
processors that feature a random number generator on hardware, which can be used for various data encryption services for greater security in network-based transactions.

We tested it on a VIA micro ATX motherboard based on the CLE266 chipset. The board comes with integrated graphics and onboard 6-channel sound. The embedded MPEG 2 decoder promises smooth DVD playback. It also has support for USB 2.0 and FireWire, and an onboard LAN chip.

We ran the PCMark 2002 benchmark, and got a CPU index of 1130—much lower than the scores given by competing processors. It took 279

seconds to encode an MPEG file to DivX. This is twice the time taken by the AMD Athlon 1800+.

The ZDBench Content Creation 2003 score was 7.8, ruling out multimedia content creation. It yielded a playable frame rate in the *Quake III* test, but without an AGP slot, there's no way you can upgrade. The CPU-motherboard combination is powerful enough to play DVD videos and music without any hiccups, but when it comes to serious computing tasks, the system simply fails.



SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: 1 GHz clock speed, 133 MHz FSB, 128 KB L1 cache, 64 KB full speed L2 cache, support for SSE instruction set, socket 370 interface

Motherboard: Support for socket 370 processors, upto 2 GB DDR SDRAM, integrated graphics chip and MPEG 2 decoder, onboard audio and LAN chip, USB 2.0 and FireWire support

Price: Rs 2,350 for C3 1 GHz processor; Rs 4,750 for C3M266 motherboard

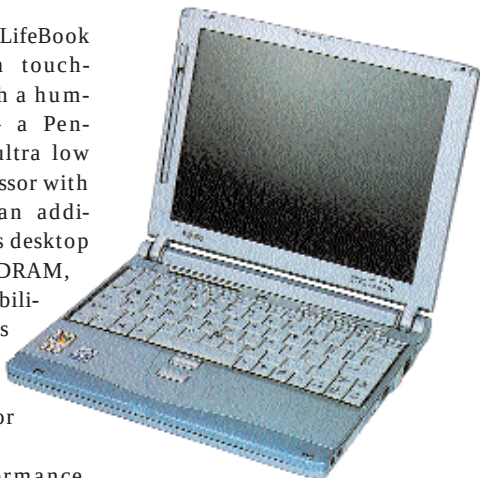
Contact: Priya Ltd
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E-mail: prom_bom@priyagroup.com
Web site: www.via.com.tw

VIA C3 Processor on VIA C3M266 Motherboard		B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
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Fujitsu Lifebook B2620

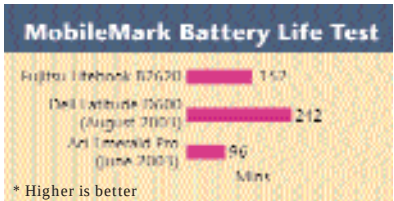
Featherweight notebook

The Fujitsu B2620 LifeBook has a 10.4-inch touch-screen TFT LCD, with a humble configuration—a Pentium III 850 MHz ultra low voltage mobile processor with 512 KB of cache—an additional 256 KB over its desktop variant; 256 MB SDRAM, and an ATI Rage Mobility 8 MB graphics card. The biggest drawback is the absence of a CD or DVD drive.



To check performance, we ran Content Creation 2003 from ZDBench—the B2620 scored a respectable 17.2. In the SiSoft benchmark, it gave a slow drive index of 11776, due to the slow 30 GB 4,200 rpm hard drive. In the processor benchmark, it scored well—1137 Whetstones and 2308 Dhrystones for integer and floating point computations, respectively. To test battery life, we used MobileMark 2002 from BAPCo, which showed a battery life of 152 minutes—low compared with the Centrino-based Dell Latitude D600, which logged 242 minutes. Overall, this notebook is best suited for the corporate user, who

mainly uses office applications and presentation software. It is over-priced at Rs 1,20,000, since you can get a Centrino-based notebook for as much.



SPECIFICATIONS

Intel Pentium III Mobile 850 MHz processor, 256 MB SDRAM, 30 GB Hitachi hard drive, 10.4 inch TFT LCD display, ATI Rage Mobility graphics card with 8 MB RAM, Windows XP Professional

Price: Rs 1,20,000
Contact: ACI Infocom
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Fax: 022-2825 0674
E-mail: jason@aciinfo.com
Web site: www.fujitsu.com

Fujitsu Lifebook B2620		B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
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